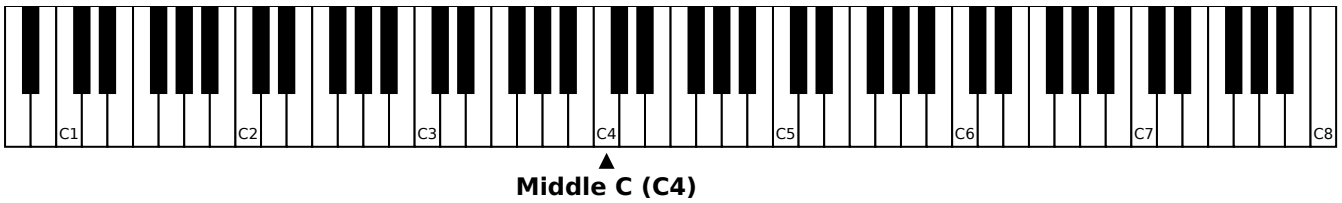
The Keyboard

The piano keyboard shows pitch from left to right. Keys to the right sound higher; keys to the left sound lower. A full piano has 88 keys: 52 white keys and 36 black keys.



The full piano keyboard, A0 to C8. Each C is labeled with its octave number.

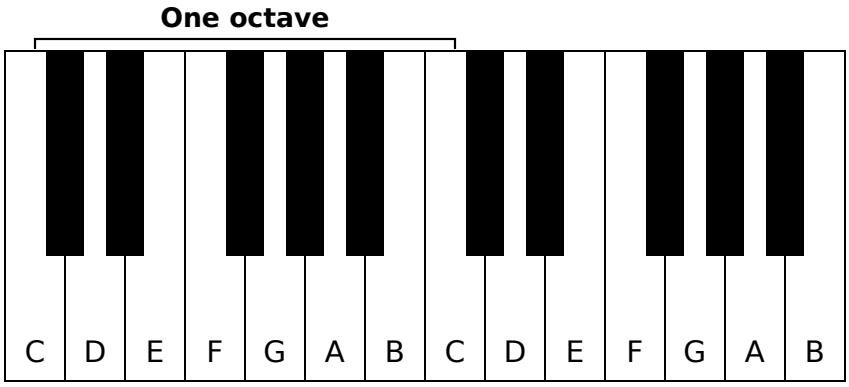
Middle C is the C closest to the middle of the piano keyboard. It is labeled C4. Octave numbers are explained in Chapter 4.

Groups of black keys

The black keys form groups of two and groups of three, repeating across the keyboard. These groups are the landmarks for finding every white key. The white keys are named with the musical alphabet, A to G, repeating.

- C is the white key immediately to the left of each group of two black keys.
- F is the white key immediately to the left of each group of three black keys.

From C, the letters continue to the right: C D E F G A B, then C again.



Two octaves with the white keys labeled.

An **octave** is the distance from one key to the next key with the same letter name. Counting C D E F G A B C gives eight letters, which is where the word comes from. Every C on the keyboard sounds like every other C, higher or lower.

The black keys also have names. They are named in Chapter 11.

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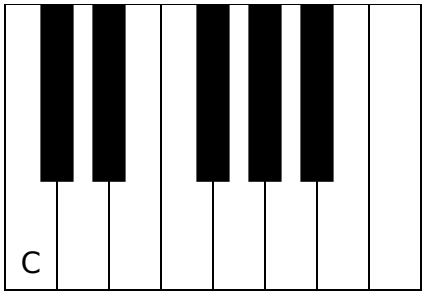
Name _____ Date _____

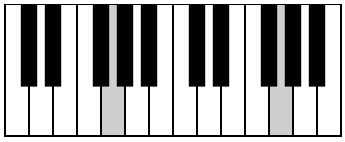
The Keyboard

A. Label the white keys Write the letter name on each white key. The C is labeled as the example.

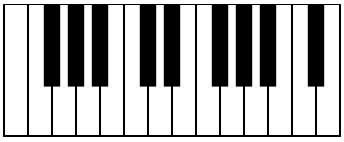


B. Shade the keys Shade every key named in each item.

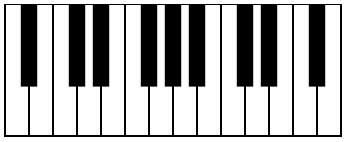
EXAMPLE Shade every G.



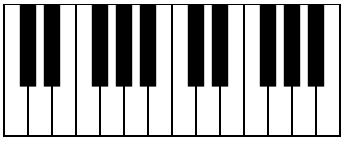
1. Shade every C.



2. Shade every F.

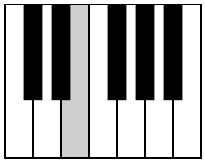


3. Shade every F, A, and D.



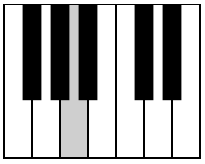
C. Name the shaded key Write the letter name of each shaded key.

EXAMPLE

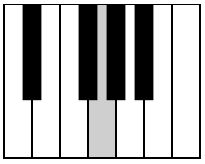


E

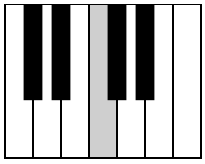
1.



2.



3.



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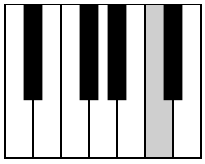

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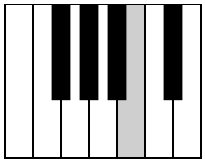

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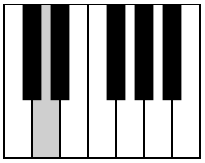

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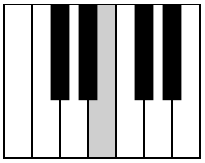

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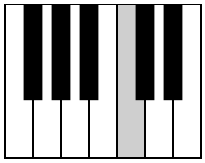

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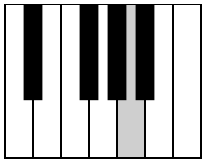
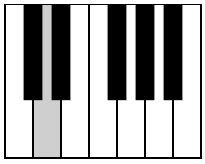


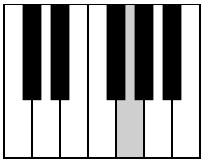
D. Neighboring keys Name the white key to the left and the white key to the right of each shaded key.

EXAMPLE



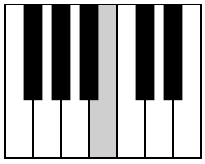
Left C Right E

1.



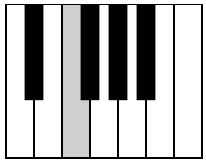
Left _____ Right _____

2.



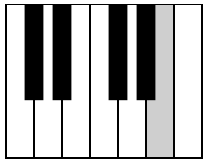
Left _____ Right _____

3.



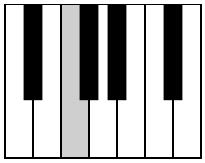
Left _____ Right _____

4.



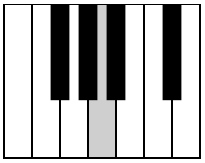
Left _____ Right _____

5.



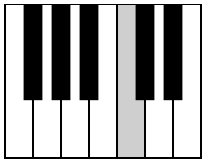
Left _____ Right _____

6.



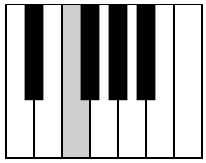
Left _____ Right _____

7.



Left _____ Right _____

8.



Left _____ Right _____

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